AUDIENCE FEEDBACK AND ENGAGEMENT

What does your audience have to say?

Audience Feedback

Introduction:

Feedback is the verbal and non-verbal responses from an audience which help the speaker modify and regulate what s/he is saying. This means that you should be able to apply your observations of feedback from your audience to modify your speech.

Feedback is the response that listeners provide to the sender of the message. Feedback is a cue to the speaker to modify or regulate what is being said. Feedback can take the form of verbal or non-verbal responses to an in-person speech, or verbal responses which are electronically captured for large or remote audiences

Types of feedback

1. Verbal feedback:

During the speech you may solicit feedback from the audience by asking a simple question. Audience members may respond verbally or they may nod or raise their hands. Additionally, audience members may ask a question or let you know if they do not understand. You may also receive direct positive or negative feedback from members of the audience who agree or disagree with what you are saying. Listen for the verbal feedback and acknowledge it.

Types of feedback

2. Non-Verbal feedback:

When you are in front of the audience, non-verbal behaviour can be an important cue to what the audience understands, the level of attentiveness, excitement or agreement, or confusion or disagreement. The non-verbal feedback may be intentional vocalizations, such as groans or encouragement (such as clapping). However, much of the non-verbal feedback may be unconscious physical body language, which can provide feedback for you. Here are some examples of body language that you may notice displayed consciously or subconsciously by members of the audience:

- Boredom: boredom is indicated by the eyes looking straight at the speaker but becoming slightly unfocused.
- Disbelief: this is often indicated by averted gaze or by touching the ear or scratching the chin.
- Attentive eye contact: Are audience members looking directly at you attentively or are they looking around? Consistent eye contact can indicate that a person is interested and thinking positively about the speaker's subject.
- Body position and posture: Audience members will generally face the speaker while listening intently; if the audience members are not interested they may shift the body position to the side rather than toward the speaker.

Timing of feedback

Assessment, of feedback, is often divided into initial, formative, and summative categories.

- Initial assessment, also referred to as pre-assessment or diagnostic assessment, is conducted prior to instruction or intervention to establish a baseline from which an individual's growth can be measured.
- Formative assessment is generally carried out throughout a course or project. Formative assessment, also referred to as "educative assessment," is used to aid learning. Formative assessments can take the form of standardized tests.
- Summative assessment is generally carried out at the end of a course, project or speech. In an educational setting, summative assessments are typically used to assign students a course grade. Whereas following a speech or presentation, summative assessment can be provided in the form of positive feedback, applause or a standing ovation

Question and Answer session

"Any questions?"

As a member of the audience in many speeches, this has probably been your favourite part of the speech. For many speakers, this is one of the scariest parts. This is the true test of how you will be perceived.

We cover some issues you should take note of before asking that ultimate question:

- You should anticipate questions and prepare for them
- You can set some standards/rules for the Q&A session: when and in what order.
- When answering questions, do the following:

➢ Listen to the whole question

➢ Understand the context, ask for clarification if need be

➢ Keep your response to-the-point and don't ramble

➢ You can choose to deflect the question, or defer to a later time and date



ANY QUESTIONS?